

Request for Information – Registry Platform Resource Augmentation

1. Objectives

The objective of this RFI is for the Australian Securities and Investments Commission (ASIC) to obtain options from the market on providing ASIC with a resourcing model for ASIC's legacy Registry environments.

Responses to this RFI will assist ASIC in developing an appropriate model and then, subject to business requirements, to possibly issue an RFQ, contingent on funding being secured through MYEFO/Budget processes, to procure a solution based on that model.

2. Background

2.1 Context

The responsibility for stabilising and uplifting the ASIC Registers was returned to ASIC with closure of the Modernising Business Register (MBR) Program in September 2023. ASIC is having to manage a significant risk with the ongoing support of these aging systems and applications whilst the new registry environments are designed and built within ASIC. ASIC is seeking a supplier that can provide and manage the skilled resources to support these legacy systems over a potential 3–5-year period.

At a high-level ASIC is considering engaging suppliers who will:

- (1) Provide ASIC with IT professionals who have experience, skills and knowledge in supporting software development and infrastructure activities which can help to maintain and enhance the ASIC Registry Platforms.
- (2) Provide ASIC with resources to support hardware infrastructure for the ASIC Registry Platforms.

Through this RFI, suppliers are invited to propose resourcing models and suggest ideas to ASIC with the objective of ASIC identifying the best overall solution providing a resourcing model for a possible future procurement.

2.2 Key Dates and Activities

The following are indicative activities and timeframes for this RFI:

Activity	Estimated Timeframe
RFI Issue Date	30 September 2024
RFI Question Close Date	25 October 2024

RFI Close Date and Time	01 November 2024
-------------------------	------------------

2.3 Definitions/Acronyms

Definitions/Acronyms used within this document:

Acronym	Description
ABN	Australian Business Number
ABR	Australian Business Register
ACN	Australian Company Number
ACSC	Australian Cyber Security Centre
ADFS	Active Directory Federation Services
AGISM	Australian Government Information Security Manual
AGSVA	Australian Government Security Vetting Agency
ASB	ASIC Suitability and Baseline Assessment (ASB)
ASD	Australian Signals Directorate
ASIC	Australian Securities and Investments Commission
ATO	Australian Taxation Office
BAU	Business as Usual
DTA	Digital Transformation Agency
FAR	Financial Advisors Register
MoBR / MBR	Registry Transformation / Modernisation of Business Registers
PMO	Program Management Office
PSPF	Australian Government Protective Security Policy Framework
RACI	Responsibility Assignment Matrix
RFI	Request for Information
RT	Regulatory Transformation
SEL	Senior Executive Leader
SME	Subject Matter Expert
SOR	Statement of Requirements
SOW	Statement of Work
E8	Essential Eight Maturity Model

2.4 Compliance

Under any resourcing model that ASIC implements, the supplier will be expected to ensure that ASIC complies with the requirements of the:

- Protected Security Policy Framework (PSPF)
- Australian Cyber Security Centre (ACSC)
- Australian Signals Directorate (ASD)
- Privacy Act 1988
- Australian Government ACSC Information Security Manual (ISM)
- WGE Compliance Letter (Digital Marketplace Comprehensive Terms clause 27)

- All deliverables and outputs should conform to the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.0 (specifying Level A, AA or AAA), preferably through the use of Sufficient Techniques (as that term is defined in the WCAG 2.0 Quick Reference <http://www.w3org/WAI/WCAG20/quickref/>)
- The supplier must implement and maintain a documented Environmental Management System as defined in ISO 14001 which is a structured system designed to help organisations manage their environmental impacts and improve environmental performance caused by their products, services and activities and the supplier's Environmental Management System must address the requirements of ISO14001:2015 Environmental Management Systems.

3. Particulars of the Solution

This section specifies ASIC's expectations for a proposed future resource augmentation service comprised of software developers and infrastructure support personnel who are anticipated will work on the ASIC Registry Platforms under the direction of ASIC's Technology Team.

3.1 Scope

It is anticipated that suppliers will provide ASIC with qualified and experienced software developers who can support the maintenance, development and enhancement of the ASIC Registry Platforms, a critical ASIC system over the 2025 – 2030 timeframe.

Suppliers may also have the opportunity to provide support and maintenance of the IT hardware infrastructure that supports the ASIC Registry Platforms.

Information regarding the technologies (software and hardware) comprising the ASIC Registry Platform, the size and competencies of the existing teams and indicative information regarding product roadmaps will be provided on request: at a high level, the ASIC Registry Platform is the hardware and software environment supporting the ASIC registers described below:

Business Name Register	Professional Registers		Historical Registers	
Australian Business Names Register	Auditors Register	Liquidators Register	Company Charges Register	Futures Representatives Register
Company Registers	Australian Financial Services Licensee (AFSL) Register	Managed Investment Schemes Register (MISM)	Carbon Registrants Register	General Insurance Brokers Register
	Authorised Representatives of AFSL Register	Official Liquidators Register (transition to historical)	Credit Registered Persons Register	Licence Holders Register
	Australian Credit Licensee Register	Self-Managed Superannuation Fund (SMSF) Auditor Register	Foreign Insurance Agents Register	Life Insurance Brokers Register
	Australian Credit Representatives Register	Trustees for Debenture Holders Register	Futures Licensees Register	Securities Representatives Register
	Asian Region Funds Passport Register	Unlicensed Carried Over Instrument Lenders Register		
Australian Companies Register	Financial Adviser Register	Banned & Disqualified Registers		
Foreign Companies Register				
Registrable Australian Bodies Register				
Reserved Company Names Register				
		Disqualified Persons Register	Australian Financial Services (AFS) Banned/Disqualified Persons Register	
		SMSF Auditors Banned/Disqualified Persons Register	Banned Futures Representative Register (pre-AFS)	
		Credit Banned/Disqualified Persons Register	Banned Securities Representatives Register (pre-AFS)	

3.2 Objectives

The objectives of the resourcing model, if implemented, will be to provide ASIC with a pool of software developers with the relevant skills, knowledge and experience to maintain, develop and enhance the ASIC Registry Platform. The supplier's pool of software developers is intended to be closely integrated with the ASIC Technology Team.

The Core Skills for the software developers are envisaged to be:

1. Mainframe programming - ADABAS Natural, JCL
2. WebSphere MQ
3. Informix Database Administration
4. Java programming, Java Spring Framework
5. XML/XSLT knowledge/skills
6. C / C++ programming
7. Oracle Fusion Middleware including WebLogic, Oracle SOA, BPEL, Oracle Content Management, WebCenter/ADF Framework, and Oracle IAM stack.
8. Oracle Linux System Administration
9. Oracle Solaris Unix System Administration
10. CORBA programming

The Core Skills for the IT Hardware infrastructure support is envisaged to be:

1. IBM DataPower Gateway
2. IBM Mainframe z15 T02
3. Oracle Sparc Hardware (M12 and S7)

Provided that the Core Skills are always included, suppliers may propose additional and alternative skills for the pool of software developers. In considering this option, suppliers should note the following skills and technologies (Adjacent Skills) are in use at ASIC and ASIC is interested to understand suppliers' current relevant capability:

- Siebel COTs application configuration/development and support
- Oracle Database management and PL/SQL Programming
- ADABAS database management
- Mainframe Systems Programming
- Unix scripting advanced knowledge

ASIC is interested in developing an operating model where the suppliers' pool of software developers and the ASIC Technology Team would be tightly integrated. ASIC intends to not hire staff itself but to progressively increase the size of its supplier pool. ASIC expects suppliers will develop relevant reporting for all aspects of the work on the Registry Platform and become a key stakeholder in business planning for the ASIC Registry Platform. ASIC contemplates the suppliers' pool of software developers growing over the years.

Initially, suppliers would be expected to deliver a pool of six (6) software developers with the Core Skills, but ASIC envisages the pool may eventually comprise up to twenty (20) software developers during the proposed contract term. Suppliers should describe how they see this integration working, including addressing transition and onboarding questions.

Currently, the support for Infrastructure and Applications by ASIC FTEs or third party as mentioned below:

Infrastructure/Application	FTEs
An IBM Z15 system running z/OS and ADABAS	1
SPARC systems running Solaris	1.5
IBM DataPower	1
Mainframe Systems Programming	Third party Managed
ADABAS on Mainframe	Third party Managed
ADABAS on UNIX	1
Informix DBA	1
WebSphere MQ	1
Oracle Fusion Middleware	2
Oracle DBA	1.5
Oracle Linux System Admin	2
Mainframe Programmers	6
Java Programmers	3
C/C++ Programmers	1

ASIC is interested in how suppliers might take over the SPARC environment using a resource augmentation model. Suppliers should also outline a proposed to transition to an SLA based outsourced model during the contract term

Suppliers should also explain the extent to which and how they might employ existing ASIC staff (software and hardware skillsets) to best deliver on the resource augmentation arrangement.

Suppliers should also provide information on how they would propose to transition the support services from ASIC's current support staff to a new team and the duration for an effective transfer of skills and knowledge.

Under the proposed resourcing model, suppliers must:

- ensure that the software developers deliver high-quality software solutions that meet ASIC's business needs and comply with ASIC's standards and policies
- enable ASIC to manage the software developers' performance, workload, and allocation in a flexible and efficient manner
- reduce for ASIC the risks and costs associated with hiring, training, and retaining software developers for the ASIC Registry Platform

and suppliers are encouraged to explain how they would deliver on these commitments.

3.3 Solution Deliverables

The deliverables that would be considered in an effective resourcing model are:

- A pool of software developers possessing the Core Skills who are available to work for the ASIC Registry Platform on a full-time or part-time basis, as required by ASIC
- Software solutions that are developed, maintained, and enhanced by the software developers for the ASIC Registry Platform, in accordance with ASIC's specifications, requirements, and timelines
- Documentation, testing, and support for the software solutions that are delivered by the software developers for the ASIC Registry Platform
- A hardware support and maintenance solution providing the objectives in s3.2 above
- Regular reports and feedback on all aspects of the services.

3.4 Roles and Responsibilities

ASIC has included below the potential roles and responsibilities that could operate under a successful resourcing model. However, ASIC would welcome input from respondents on other proposed operating models under which a Staff Augmentation arrangement could operate:

ASIC:

- ensuring that ASIC business SME's will be available to assist the Supplier as required
- providing the necessary workspace and equipment to personnel to perform the services.

ASIC's Technology Team:

- responsible for providing the direction, guidance, and supervision for the software developers who work on the ASIC Registry Platform
- defining the scope, specifications, and priorities of the software projects, assigning the tasks and deliverables to the software developers, monitoring and evaluating their performance and providing feedback and support.
- coordinating with the suppliers and the software developers to manage the service contracts and their day-to-day administration.

Supplier:

- responsible for providing ASIC with a pool of software developers with the Core Skills who meet the qualification and experience criteria specified by ASIC
- managing the recruitment, training, and retention of the software developers, ensuring that they comply with ASIC's standards and policies, and handling the payroll, benefits, and expenses of the software developers
- communicating and collaborating with ASIC's Technology Team and the software developers on the contract execution and issues resolution
- establishing and reporting to ASIC on how the suppliers manage the software developers, including the metrics for measuring the quality, productivity, and satisfaction of the software developers and their work.

Software Developers:

- responsible for working on the ASIC Registry Platform under the direction of ASIC's Technology Team

- will perform the tasks and produce the deliverables assigned to them by ASIC's Technology Team, adhere to the quality and timeliness standards set by ASIC, and report and document their work
- will also follow the instructions and feedback from the Technology Team, the Supplier, and ASIC's stakeholders.

4. Instructions for responding

4.1 No fees will be paid for responses to this RFI

This RFI is not an offer or commitment to engage or to contract with any supplier who responds to it or to pay for any service provided by a respondent by responding to this RFI.

No fee or cost will be paid by ASIC in relation to the preparation or submission of any response to this RFI nor in relation to the content of such response or subsequent clarification.

Information in responses to this RFI may be shared by ASIC with other suppliers to define the scope and particulars of a resourcing solution, if procurement of such a solution proceeds in future. However, information identified in responses as being a supplier's intellectual property or confidential information will not be disclosed by ASIC to any third party.

4.2 Information to be included in responses to this RFI

In responding to this RFI, suppliers should include the following:

1. A concise description of how the supplier would deliver the services.
2. An overview of the approach and methodology to deliver the services
3. High level project plan covering transition in, integration of Supplier personnel with the ASIC Technology Team, development of MIS reporting and related activities for all services
4. Alternative solution strategies and additional strategic observations